

STARTUP CONSULTING — CONFIDENTIAL REPORT

Customer & MVP Blueprint

AI-Powered Career Assistant Platform · India Market

Generated: June 23, 2026 | Stage: Pre-Validation | Type: Startup (High Growth)

EdTech / CareerTech

AI-Powered

India First

B2C · Freemium

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Executive Summary

Component	Details
Startup Idea	An AI-powered platform helping Indian students & fresh graduates build hireable career profiles — covering resume optimization, ATS analysis, LinkedIn guidance, JD matching, skill-gap identification, and personalized roadmaps.
Target Users	CS/IT/DS students (18–25 yrs), fresh graduates (0–2 yrs exp), Tier 1–3 Indian colleges, actively job-hunting in the tech sector.
Core Problem	Skilled graduates don't know why they're being rejected. Poor resume structure, zero ATS knowledge, no career mentor, and unaffordable coaching leave them stuck.
Opportunity	No dominant AI-native career platform exists for India's 1.5M+ annual engineering graduates. The gap between generic free tools and expensive coaches is wide open.

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Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Dimension	Profile	Insight
Segment	CS/IT/DS students & fresh grads	Largest homogeneous pain group
Age	18 – 25 years	Digital-native, mobile-first
Profession	Student / Entry-level Tech	Pre-revenue, price sensitive
Location	Tier 2 & 3 Indian cities (UP, Bihar, MP, Rajasthan)	Underserved by coaching market
Behavior	Active on LinkedIn, GitHub, Internshala; watches YouTube tutorials	High digital intent, low conversion
Goals	Land first internship/job, build recruiter-ready profile, know what to learn next	Emotional + career urgency
Needs	Personalized AI guidance, ATS-ready resume, affordable coaching alternative	Actionable, not generic

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Buyer Persona

Attribute	Details
Name / Role	Rohit Verma — 3rd year CS student, VIT Bhopal
Background	Knows Python, SQL, built 2 ML projects. Self-taught via YouTube. No placement mentor. Family has no corporate background.
Goals	Crack a ₹5–8 LPA tech offer before final year. Compete with IIT peers. Get recruiter DMs on LinkedIn.
Frustrations	Applied to 40+ roles with 0 callbacks. Doesn't know what ATS is. Generic resume advice online doesn't match his profile.

Current Solutions	ChatGPT for resume tips (hit-or-miss), free Canva templates, watching 'How to get a job' YouTube videos.
Decision Factors	Sees a peer land a job using the platform. Tries free tier. Hits a paywall during placement panic. Converts to paid.

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Top 10 Customer Pain Points

#	Pain Point	Severity	Why It Matters
1	Resume not passing ATS filters	■ Critical	First barrier; invisible to candidates
2	No feedback on why applications fail	■ Critical	Causes helplessness and churn from job market
3	Unclear which skills to learn next	■ High	Wastes months on wrong courses
4	LinkedIn profile not attracting recruiters	■ High	Missed inbound opportunities daily
5	Can't decode job descriptions accurately	■ High	Over/under-applying; low match rate
6	Expensive human career coaches	■ High	■5K–20K is out of reach for most
7	Generic advice doesn't fit their profile	■ Medium	Low trust in free content
8	No roadmap from 'where I am' to 'hired'	■ Medium	Creates paralysis and inaction
9	Difficulty comparing self vs job requirements	■ Medium	Can't prioritize preparation
10	Lack of mock interview / soft skill prep	■ Lower	Important but not Day-1 urgent

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Customer Journey Map

Stage	User Actions	Pain / Problem	Product Opportunity
Awareness	Sees LinkedIn post, WhatsApp group share, YouTube short	Doesn't know why applications fail	Free resume audit hook — instant score on upload
Consideration	Uploads resume, reads score, explores features	Skeptical: 'Is this better than ChatGPT?'	Show side-by-side before/after; testimonials
Activation	Uses 3+ features, gets ATS report, sees skill gaps	Hits paywall during high-urgency placement period	Convert with time-limited ■99 trial or placement-season offer
Retention	Returns weekly for new JD matches, roadmap updates	Loses motivation if no visible progress	Weekly progress digest email; milestone badges
Advocacy	Shares with college batch, refers friends after getting hired	Doesn't think to refer unless prompted	'I got hired!' success stories; referral rewards

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Customer Objections & Counters

Objection	Root Cause	Counter Strategy
"Is this better than free ChatGPT?"	Trust / Value clarity	Show instant side-by-side ATS score vs raw ChatGPT output. Demo specificity wins.
"I can't afford █299/month"	Price sensitivity	Generous free tier + █99 trial. Placement-season urgency unlocks willingness to pay.
"My college placement cell does this"	Perceived substitute	TPO advice is generic and overburdened. Show the AI advantage: instant, personalized, 24/7.
"What if my data is misused?"	Privacy concern	Visible data policy, no-sell guarantee, option to delete data anytime.
"I'll just use this once"	Low perceived ongoing value	Weekly JD match digest and roadmap updates create recurring return habit.

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Buying Triggers

Trigger Event	Why It Converts
Placement Season Opens	Campus drives start in Aug–Oct and Jan–Mar. Panic triggers paid conversion.
Friend Gets Shortlisted	Social proof is the #1 trigger. One success story in a batch creates a wave.
Another Rejection Email	Emotional low point drives action. Catch users immediately post-rejection.
Recruiter Doesn't Reply	Prolonged silence motivates profile overhaul — prime conversion moment.
Sees a LinkedIn 'Hired' Post	Aspirational trigger. User wonders 'how did they do it?' — platform answers.
Skill Gap Report Shock	Seeing specific missing skills creates urgency to act NOW, not later.

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MVP Recommendation

What to Build First

- Resume Upload + Instant AI Score (0–100) with top 3 specific fixes
- ATS Keyword Gap Report vs a pasted Job Description
- Skill Gap Identifier: 'You need X, Y, Z for this role'
- Simple Dashboard showing profile completeness %

What NOT to Build Initially

- LinkedIn API integration (auth complexity, API limits)
- Mock interview module (scope creep — defer to v2)
- Mobile app (validate web first)
- Full learning management system or course platform

Success Metrics for MVP

Metric	Target (Day 30)	What it Proves
Waitlist signups	200+	Demand exists
Resume uploads (free)	100+	Core feature engagement
Return visits (>1x)	>40%	Retention signal
Paid conversions	5–10 users	Willingness to pay validated
NPS / satisfaction	>7/10	Product-market fit signal

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MoSCoW Feature Prioritization

MUST HAVE	Resume upload + AI audit score, ATS keyword analysis vs JD, Skill gap identification, Top 3 personalized fix suggestions, User account + profile storage
SHOULD HAVE	LinkedIn profile improvement tips, Personalized 30-day career roadmap, Email digest of weekly progress, Multiple resume versions, Saved JD history
COULD HAVE	Job portal integration (Naukri/LinkedIn scrape), Peer benchmark scores, Mentor connect marketplace, Interview question bank by role, Resume template library
WON'T HAVE (v1)	Mobile app, Video mock interviews, Full LMS / course platform, AI cover letter generator, Browser extension

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Pricing Hypothesis

Plan	Price	Features	Rationale
Free	₹0	1 resume audit/month, basic score, top 3 fixes	Acquisition engine — maximise signups, create habit
Starter	₹99/mo	5 audits, JD matching, skill gap report	Low-friction trial; converts placement-panic users
Pro	₹299/mo	Unlimited audits, roadmap, LinkedIn tips, history	Core revenue tier; target 5–10% of free users
Annual Pro	₹1,999/yr	All Pro features at 44% discount	Improves LTV, reduces monthly churn significantly

Reasoning: Indian students are highly price-sensitive. ₹99 removes friction for first paid transaction. ₹299 is the sustainable tier. Annual plan at ~₹167/mo anchors value perception. B2B college license (₹50K–2L/institution/year) is the path to accelerated revenue.

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Top 5 Risks

Risk	Level	Description	Mitigation
Market Risk	Medium	Students may not pay consistently; seasonal demand spikes	B2B college licensing provides predictable revenue baseline
User Adoption	Medium	Habit formation is hard; users try once and forget	Weekly email digest, milestone progress, placement-season nudges
Competition	High	LinkedIn / Naukri / Unstop could ship a competing feature	Move fast; build India-specific depth they can't replicate quickly
Execution	Medium	Scope is wide for a solo founder; risk of building wrong features	Strict MVP discipline; manual concierge before automating
Monetization	Medium	Freemium-to-paid conversion rates in India are typically <5%	Placement-season urgency + generous free tier drives conversion spikes

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30-Day MVP Execution Plan

- Week 1

Discovery & Problem Interviews
 - Interview 20 students: 'Why haven't you landed a job yet?'
 - Join 5 college placement WhatsApp groups — observe real pain
 - Review 50 LinkedIn profiles of CS freshers — map common resume errors
 - Define your single 'wow moment' feature based on interviews
 - Document top 3 pain points with verbatim quotes from users
- Week 2

Landing Page & Waitlist Validation
 - Build a Framer/Carrrd landing page with 1 sharp value proposition
 - Offer free 'Resume Score' lead magnet to capture emails
 - Share across LinkedIn, Reddit (r/developersIndia), college groups
 - Target: 200+ signups — validates demand before any code
 - Track UTM source to identify your best acquisition channel
- Week 3

Concierge MVP — Manual AI Delivery
 - Deliver AI-powered resume audits manually to first 20 waitlist users
 - Use Claude/GPT with a custom career prompt as your 'AI engine'
 - Time each audit: this defines your automation priority for Week 4
 - Collect structured feedback: Most useful? Missing? Would you pay?
 - Identify the single feature with highest 'wow factor' per user
- Week 4

Proof-of-Concept Build & Pricing Test
 - Build minimal web app: resume upload → AI score → top 3 fixes
 - Test 2 pricing tiers with split user groups (₹99 vs ₹299)
 - Ask 5 users for payment — any payment validates willingness to pay
 - Document conversion rate, drop-off points, top feature requests
 - Decision: build full product OR pivot based on real usage data

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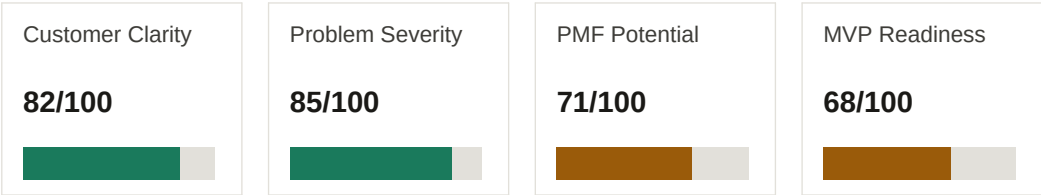
Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

When	Action
TODAY	Write down your hypothesis: Who is the customer, what is the problem, what is the solution.
Day 1–2	DM 20 CS students or freshers on LinkedIn — ask for a 10-min problem interview.
Day 3	Join 5 college placement WhatsApp groups and observe conversations for 48 hours.
Day 4–5	Conduct 10 problem interviews. Record verbatim pain points. Don't pitch yet.
Day 6	Build a 1-page landing page with a waitlist form. No product needed.
Day 7	Share landing page in all communities. Target 50 signups in 48 hours.
Day 8–10	Manually deliver 5 resume audits using Claude/GPT. Measure 'wow factor.'

Day 11	Interview 3 campus TPO/placement officers — understand their pain too (B2B angle).
Day 14	Decide your MVP scope: 1 feature only. Start building or no-code prototype.
Day 30	Demo to 20 users. Ask for payment. Document every 'yes', 'no', and 'why'.

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Validation Scores



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Final Verdict

■ PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

The problem is real, widespread, and emotionally urgent. The founder has strong technical ability and lives the user problem — a major advantage. The Indian market is meaningfully underserved with no dominant AI-native career platform.

However, zero user validation exists today. The verdict will upgrade to **Strong Demand Signal** if the 30-day sprint delivers: 200+ waitlist signups, 5+ paying users, and an NPS above 7/10.

Key watch-out: Scope discipline is critical. Build ONE feature that creates a genuine 'wow' moment before expanding. The biggest risk is building everything and validating nothing.